

42 Obligations

In English, you can use “have to” or “must” when talking about obligations or things that are necessary. You may hear it in important instructions such as medical advice.

⚙️ **New language** “Must” and “have to”

Aa **Vocabulary** Health and sickness

🧩 **New skill** Expressing obligation

42.1 KEY LANGUAGE OBLIGATIONS

“Must” and “have to” both express a strong need or obligation to do something.



You **must** / **have to** rest, or your leg won't heal.

“Must not” is a strong negative obligation. It means something is not allowed.



You **must not** get your bandage wet, or your leg might not heal properly.

“Don't have to” means something is not necessary, or there is no obligation.



You **don't have to** come again. Your leg is better.



42.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES OBLIGATIONS

He **must** take two pills each morning and evening for the next two weeks.



She **mustn't** go back to work until her back is better.



Do I have to go back to the doctor again? I'm feeling so much better now.



42.3 HOW TO FORM OBLIGATIONS

“Must” does not change with the subject, but “have to” becomes “has to” in the third person singular. Both forms are followed by the base form of the main verb.

SUBJECT	“MUST / HAVE TO”	MAIN VERB	OBJECT
She	must has to must not doesn't have to	take	this medicine.